

Book I - The Sagent Creed
Part 5 - Sheep Among Wolves

Chapter 22 - The Blue to the Green

Chapter 22: The Blue to the Green

The Blue Lightsaber

For two years, I carried a blue lightsaber.

Not literally. But in every way that matters, the lightsaber was blue. I was working inside someone else's structure, advancing someone else's mission, following someone else's chain of command, believing — genuinely believing — that this was how you change the world. You find the biggest, most effective organization aligned with your values. You join it. You rise through it. You work the system from the inside. You make eighty phone calls every two weeks. You organize chapters. You recruit students. You show up to every meeting and hit every metric and trust that the organization's reach will amplify your effort into something larger than yourself.

I was a state chair for Young Americans for Liberty. YAL. The largest libertarian youth organization in the country. Thousands of members. Hundreds of campuses. A professional operation with national calls, regional directors, performance reviews, talking points. I believed in the mission: liberty. I believed in the method: organize, educate, activate. I believed that the blue lightsaber — the inherited weapon, the one given to you by the institution, the one that connects you to a tradition larger than yourself — was the right tool for the fight.

I was good at it. Eighty calls every other week. Chapter growth. Event coordination. The metrics said I was performing. The structure said I was rising. The blue lightsaber was doing what blue lightsabers do: cutting, connecting, advancing along the lines the institution had drawn.

The Call

In June 2025, the United States bombed Iran's nuclear facilities.

This was the kind of moment that reveals what an organization actually is, as opposed to what it says it is. YAL's stated principles included opposition to military interventionism. The non-aggression principle. The conviction that bombing foreign countries is not defense but aggression, and that a free people do not need an empire. These were not footnotes. These were foundational. These were the principles that had drawn me to the organization in the first place.

On the national call, the position from leadership was support — or at least non-opposition — for the bombing. The reasoning was strategic: the political moment required alignment with the administration, and opposing the strikes would isolate YAL from its allies in the broader conservative movement.

I disagreed. On the call, openly, to my boss. I took the antiwar position — the position that aligned with YAL's own stated principles, the position that said bombing a sovereign nation is the initiation of force regardless of the justification, the position that a libertarian organization that supports foreign bombing has stopped being libertarian in any meaningful sense.

A few days later, I was let go.

The Lesson

The lesson was not that YAL was corrupt. The lesson was not that my boss was a bad person. The lesson was not that the libertarian movement is broken or hypocritical or beyond saving. People are complicated. Organizations are more complicated. Movements are the most complicated of all. I hold no grudge and I wish the organization well, and if they ever return to the principle they were founded on, I will be the first to say so.

The lesson was about the blue lightsaber.

The blue lightsaber is inherited. It is given to you by the institution. It connects you to a lineage — Obi-Wan to Anakin to Luke. It is powerful. It is beautiful. It carries the weight of tradition and the authority of the thing that made it.

But it is not yours. And the moment the institution decides that the lightsaber should point in a direction your conscience cannot follow, you have two options: point the lightsaber where they tell you, or put it down.

I put it down.

Not because the institution was the enemy. Not because the people in it were wrong about everything. Not because the blue lightsaber has no value. But because a Sagent does not fight with a borrowed weapon. A Sagent does not advance a mission that compromises the principle for the strategy. A

Sagent does not stay inside a structure that demands obedience over conscience.

There is no chain of command between humans. If a man's command is against God's command, do God's command. If a man's command is God's command, do God's command. The middleman is not the source. The institution is not the principle. The blue lightsaber is not the Force.

The Space Between

What they do not tell you about the transition from blue to green is that there is a gap.

Luke lost his blue lightsaber on Cloud City. He did not immediately have a green one. There was a period — the time between *The Empire Strikes Back* and *Return of the Jedi* — when he had no lightsaber at all. He had lost the inherited weapon and had not yet built his own.

That gap is real. I lived in it. The months after YAL were the months when I had no structure, no organization, no chain of command, no eighty calls every other week, no metrics to hit, no one telling me what the mission was and how to advance it.

The gap is terrifying. The blue lightsaber may not be yours, but it is *something*. It gives you identity. It gives you purpose. It gives you the feeling of mattering, of being part of something larger, of having a defined role in a defined story. When you put it down, you are standing alone. No weapon. No mission. No structure. Just conscience and silence and the deeply uncomfortable question: *now what?*

The world offers two responses to this gap. The first is to pick up another blue lightsaber — find another institution, another organization, another structure to serve. The second is to give up — to decide that the fight is not worth it, that the system is too broken, that one person cannot make a difference, and to retreat into private life.

The Sagent's response is neither. The Sagent builds a green lightsaber.

The Green Lightsaber

The green lightsaber is not given. It is built.

Luke built his on Tatooine, in solitude, before the rescue of Han Solo. He built it with knowledge gained from Obi-Wan and Yoda — the inheritance of the tradition — but the construction was his own. The crystal was his own. The design was his own. The weapon that emerged was not a copy of the blue lightsaber. It was something new, something that could only exist because the maker had lost the inherited weapon and been forced to understand the Force well enough to build his own.

The green lightsaber does not inherit the mission. The green lightsaber *creates* the mission.

I stepped back after YAL and asked a question I had never asked while carrying the blue lightsaber: *What is my actual strong suit?*

Not what organization should I join. Not what movement should I serve. Not what institution needs my eighty calls every other week. What am I actually built for? What is the thing that only I can do — the intersection of lineage and training and conviction and capability that belongs to no one else?

The answer became the Living Age.

The realization was not sudden. It assembled itself the way living things assemble — gradually, from local signals, without a central plan. The Clokey legacy. The bioinformatics training. The voluntaryist philosophy. The writing. The media instinct inherited from a family that had been making stories for three generations. The engineering sensibility absorbed from a BME program that taught me to think in systems. The theological conviction that the pattern of life is the Creator's design language.

None of these things fit inside a single organization's mission. None of them could be reduced to eighty calls every other week. None of them needed a blue lightsaber.

They needed a green one.

What the Green Lightsaber Builds

The Living Age is the green lightsaber.

It is not an organization I joined. It is not a movement I was recruited into. It is not a structure someone else built that I am serving within. It is the thing I am building — the intersection of media and technology, of story and science, of *Prema* and protein-protein interaction networks, of the philosophy that explains why the world should be free and the bioinformatics that proves it already is.

The creation of the Living Age requires media to explain why and technology to show how.

Media: YouTube, books, essays, films. The stories that plant the seed. The narratives that show people what they already know but have not yet articulated — that life is decentralized, that the spiral defeats the block, that voluntary cooperation is not utopia but biology.

Technology: LivingWorks. The genome design system. The tool that translates the principle into practice — that takes the understanding of living systems and makes it usable, designable, accessible. Not a machine that controls life but a language that describes life. The gardener's tool, not the engineer's.

Both together. Story and system. The why and the how. The clay and the code. The green lightsaber is not a single blade — it is the full integration of everything the Sagent has been given, lost, learned, and built, forged into a weapon that cannot be inherited because it can only exist in the hands of the person who made it.

The Fighter and the Guardian

There is a final distinction between the blue and the green that matters.

The blue lightsaber is the weapon of the fighter. The one who enters the existing conflict, picks a side, and swings. The fighter is noble. The fighter is brave. The fighter is necessary in many moments. But the fighter operates within the terms of the existing war, and the terms of the existing war are set by the enemy.

The green lightsaber is the weapon of the guardian. The one who does not enter the existing conflict but creates a new one — or, more precisely, creates something so valuable that it *requires* guarding. The guardian does not fight because someone told him to. The guardian fights because the thing he built is alive and the thing that is alive must be protected.

The guardian chooses his own battles. The guardian defines his own mission. The guardian does not answer to a chain of command because the guardian's authority comes from the thing he is guarding, not the institution he is serving.

I was a fighter. I was a good fighter. Eighty calls every other week. Chapter growth. Event coordination. The blue lightsaber in skilled hands.

Now I am a guardian. The thing I am guarding is the Living Age. The philosophy embedded in the structure. The *Prema* encoded in the architecture. The living thing that carries the code of three generations and the seeds of a decentralized world.

The blue lightsaber taught me how to fight. The green lightsaber taught me what to fight for.

The blue lightsaber is inherited. The green lightsaber is built.

The fighter enters someone else's war. The guardian creates something worth defending.

I put down the blue. I picked up the green.

The Living Age is the green lightsaber.

The Living Age Trilogy